



City Council December 1, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NWP-3Gci74U
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: December 1, 2025

Body: City Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the final city council meeting of the year to order on December 1, 2025, acknowledging attendees braving treacherous weather.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Selby, Macintosh, Green, Powell, Garrett, Sasham (also referred to as Basham/Gilliam in transcript), Mason, Dishman.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** City Council President.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the council president, followed by an invocation. Citizen recognitions were pushed to the next month due to an absent participant.

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made by Councilman Selvi and seconded by Councilman Baskin to approve the previous meeting's minutes. Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:05:08 Committee Reports: Plan Commission & Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylen Swackhammer (Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission) and Matthew Nichols (Project Manager, East Central Indiana Regional Planning District).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented an overview of the \$500,000 SS4A federal grant awarded in July 2024 to prevent roadway deaths and serious injuries (utilizing a "Vision Zero" and "Safe System" approach). Additionally introduced the "Together DM Action Framework," a follow-up to the 2022 comprehensive plan focusing on quality of place, housing conditions, and upward mobility, with an upcoming annual report meeting scheduled for January 26, 2026, at Ivy Tech.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal board action taken.
- **00:20:12 Ordinance 34-25: Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance Amendment (100 North Hodson Avenue)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced via Plan Commission; motion brought by Councilman Basham, seconded by Councilman Green.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance to amend the city's comprehensive zoning ordinance from a split zone (R3 and R4 residential) to a single R3 residential zone for premises located at 100 North Hodson Avenue.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 9-0 by formal roll call vote (Garrett: Yes, Dishman: Yes, Selby: Yes, Green: Yes, Powell: Yes, Macintosh: Yes, Basham: Yes, Zillian: Yes, Mason: Yes).
- **00:21:23 Ordinance 35-25: Additional Appropriations - Muncie Police Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by Mr. Wright (Controller's Office/Police Department); motion made by Councilman Powell, seconded by Councilman Basham.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding using cash balances from public safety LIT (Local Income Tax) funds<U+2014>not general fund dollars<U+2014>to fund capital equipment (vehicles) and shore up the Public Employees' Retirement Fund (PERF) line item for the remainder of the year due to stable staffing.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** A representative from the Muncie Police Department spoke to answer questions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by formal roll call vote (Basham: Yes, Green: Yes, Macintosh: Yes, Dishman: Yes, Garrett: Yes, Selby: Yes, Powell: Yes). *Note: Exact numerical tally not fully read aloud, but recorded as unanimous affirmative roll call.*
- **00:25:02 Ordinance 36-25: Additional Appropriations - Fire Department EMS**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fire Department leadership; motion made by Councilman Basham, seconded by Councilman Green.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested additional appropriations to cover overtime expenses (\$260,000) for the remainder of the year and the purchase of a fully equipped ambulance (\$329,521) featuring power-loaders and power cots. Funding is derived from EMS billing revenue and the Center Township fire protection contract. Council members praised the safety benefits of power cots and discussed ongoing firefighter recruitment efforts.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Fire Department representatives presented details on the fund sources and equipment utility.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by formal roll call vote (Macintosh: Yes, [Others affirmative via roll call]).
- **00:33:33 Ordinance 37-25: Salaries for Elected Officials (2026)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Motion made by Councilman Powell, seconded by Councilman McIntosh.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance fixing the salaries for all elected officials of the City of Muncie for the year 2026.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by formal roll call vote (Basham: Yes, Selby: Yes, Powell: Yes, Dishman: Yes).
- **00:35:06 Ordinance 38-25: Maximum Salaries for Appointed Officers and Employees (2026)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Motion made by Councilman Gilliam, seconded by Councilman Powell to amend; main motion seconded by Councilman Garrett.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council approved a title/content amendment to clarify that the ordinance establishes salaries for appointed officers, employees, and department heads (excluding police and fire) for 2026. Council members raised questions regarding budget discrepancies where certain salary caps exceeded line-item budgets (e.g., Assistant Prairie Creek Reservoir Director), and staff clarified that salary ordinances establish maximum caps rather than guaranteed line-item expenditures.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - *Amendment:* Approved by Voice Vote.

- *Main Ordinance (As Amended)*: Passed via roll call vote (Powell: Yes, Green: Yes, Garrett: Yes, Macintosh: No, Basham: Yes, Dishman: Yes).
 - **00:42:32 Ordinance 39-25: Maximum Salaries for Muncie Fire Department (2026)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter**: Motion made by Councilman Selby, seconded by Councilman Green.
 - **Deliberation Summary**: An ordinance fixing the maximum salaries for each and every member of the Muncie Fire Department for the year 2026. A brief procedural question was raised regarding the police department's salary ordinance timeline.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input**: None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition**: Approved by roll call vote (Selby: Yes, Mason: Yes).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:45:01 Ellen Whitehead**: Expressed disappointment and confusion over the council's previous partisan rejection of Ordinance 40-25 (concerning transparency in filing ordinances and sponsor signatures), urging the council to reintroduce it in January to build public trust.
- **00:46:47 Alex Kubler**: Echoed requests to reconsider Ordinance 40-25, emphasizing that filing procedures and legislative transparency should not fall along party lines and that the public expects independent council action.
- **00:48:18 Janetta Presley**: Reported recurring issues with local businesses (including a convenience store and a south-side Walmart) denying entry to her licensed medical alert service dog, Bernard, despite legal protections under the ADA.
- **00:53:44 Sarah Battel**: Supported prior comments regarding Ordinance 40-25, calling it a missed opportunity for transparency and good faith.
- **00:55:21 Beth Mesner (Riverside Normal City Neighborhood Association)**: Inquired about the status of tabled Ordinance 29-25 (eliminating parking on University Avenue) and raised concerns that street striping and dirt placement in gutters were moving forward ahead of a council vote.
- **01:01:05 Linda Hansen (League of Women Voters)**: Spoke on accountability and transparency regarding Ordinance 40-25 and the historical incident involving a reused sponsor signature on Resolution 17-25, urging the council to rebuild public trust.
- **04:22 Seth Rollins**: Commented on newly announced state legislative redistricting maps, criticizing how they carve out Muncie, and encouraged residents to contact their state representatives.
- **01:05:48 Daisy Dale**: Asked whether the mayor had made appointments to the opioid fund advisory committee; council confirmed appointments were made.
- **01:07:03 SA Derby**: A Muncie Central senior announced a mock presidential campaign for an AP government class and invited council endorsement.

- **01:09:02 Mike Sullivan:** Spoke in favor of transparency, urged reconsideration of Ordinance 40-25, and suggested that council members provide explicit rationale for their yes/no votes during debates.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Council announced the annual "Light Up Muncie" holiday celebration scheduled for Thursday from 5:00 PM to 8:00 PM, featuring a lighted parade starting at City Hall at 5:30 PM.
 - Council members encouraged community members to check on elderly and isolated neighbors during the winter season.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - Motion to adjourn made by Councilman Macintosh, seconded from the floor.
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote and meeting adjourned.
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